



THE LIGHTNESS OF BEING

FALL 2026 | TRAINING COMPANION

Usui Holy Fire III Reiki Level I

Training outline



Led by Kate Gajewski

The Lightness of Being

www.bethelightness.com

2026

Your Level I journey

Holy Fire Reiki | Level I Training Course Outline

- What is Reiki?
- How does it feel?
- Science behind Reiki
- What can it be used for?
- The Reiki ideals
- The History of Reiki
- Introduction to Energy Anatomy
- Chakras
- Auras
- Meridians
- Grounding & shielding
- Ocean of Holy Love Experience
- 3 Heavens explained
- Reiki I Placement
- Gassho Meditation & Reiji-ho
- Byosen scanning
- Hands on positions for treating self
- Hands on
- Positions for treating others
- Dry bathing & clearing your energy field (Kenkyoku)
- Hands on practice

Course content tools for learning - "Reiki, The Healing Touch, First and Second Degree Manual" by William Lee Rand & added information written by Kate Gajewski.



What Reiki is and how it feels

Reiki

Spiritually Guided Life Force Energy

Broken down;

Rei- Spiritual Wisdom

Ki- Life Energy

Reiki can be used for anything and everything! Reiki energy relaxes and restores energy so that the receiver can heal whatever is needed to heal. Reiki works with all 4 bodies; mental, emotional, physical and spiritual. Reiki can help one or all of those bodies. Reiki is not to be used in replacement of a doctor, but it can complement any form of healing or recovery.

Reiki guides itself with spirit and its own wisdom. It is not the Practitioner who guides it. The Practitioner can get it to go to certain areas quicker by moving their hands, but regardless, the energy will flow where it needs to go. The healing is really guided by the wisdom of the energy and the spirit of the receiver. If the receiver is closed off to the energy, the energy can not penetrate the receiver's aura.

What does Reiki feel like?

Each person receives Reiki differently, and no session is the same!

Clients have reported feeling tingling, swirling or pulsing throughout the body as well as warming or cooling sensations. Some clients report feeling a numbness in their hands and feet. Some receivers may not feel the Reiki at all during the session, but will feel the effects afterwards. The more open a person is, the more they will feel the energy.

Science Behind Reiki

Studies show that Reiki activates the parasympathetic nervous system (AKA rest & digest mode), so the body can relax, digest and heal and this also reduces cortisol levels.

Reiki works with the Myofascial system, which is the system of connective tissue that is within your entire body, under your skin, like a stocking that covers you from head to toe. The job of the myofascial system is to hold all your parts in place AND deliver messages from brain to body, and body to brain.

It sends these messages through biophoton, literally meaning biological light. These electrical impulses are said to be the smallest spark of consciousness.

Within the body, there are 7 places where there is more fascia than anywhere else in the body. More fascia = more biophotons = more electrical impulses. (Electricity=Energy) Those 7 places on the body directly line up with the 7 major Chakras.

Science & further reading

MORE ARTICLES SUPPORTING THE POWER OF REIKI

ARTICLE 01

A review of clinical Reiki research

This 2017 review found results favoring Reiki in eight of 13 placebo-controlled studies, including encouraging findings on relaxation and wellbeing. Although results varied across studies, the review highlights promising possibilities for Reiki as a complementary approach to care.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5871310/>

ARTICLE 02

Autonomic nervous system pilot study

In a blinded pilot study of 45 adults, the Reiki group showed lower heart rate and diastolic blood pressure than the sham-treatment and rest groups. These small, measurable shifts offer an encouraging early indication that Reiki may support a more relaxed physiological state.

<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/15674004/>

ARTICLE 03

Reiki, hand massage and rheumatoid arthritis

In a randomized study of 105 people with rheumatoid arthritis, Reiki and hand massage were associated with reduced pain and fatigue. These improvements highlight the potential for Reiki to support comfort and symptom relief alongside ongoing medical care.

<https://www.rheumatologyadvisor.com/news/reiki-and-hand-massage-reduce-pain-fatigue-in-rheumatoid-arthritis/>

A NOTE ON EVIDENCE

The original notes on page 3 include fascia, biophoton and chakra explanations. These are not established biomedical mechanisms for Reiki. Research on clinical effects remains mixed; Reiki is complementary and does not replace medical care.

Evidence context: National Center for Complementary and Integrative Health



The Original Reiki Ideals

From "Reiki The Healing Touch First and Second Degree Manual" by William Lee Rand

The Original Reiki Ideals

A daily invitation

The secret art of inviting happiness

The miraculous medicine of all diseases

Just for today, do not be angry

Do not worry and be filled with gratitude

Devote yourself to your work

and be kind to people

Every morning and evening join your hands in prayer

Pray these words to your heart

And chant these words with your mouth

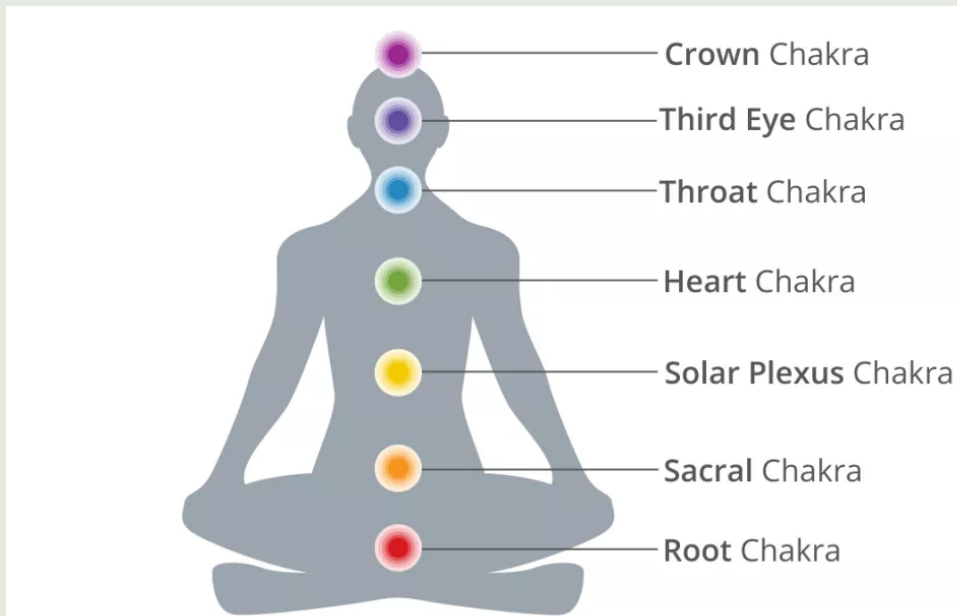
Usui Reiki Treatment for the improvement of body and mind

Chakra Love

ENERGY ANATOMY | SEVEN MAIN CHAKRAS

Chakra -> spinning wheel of energy -> 7 main chakras

These spinning wheels receive, regulate and circulate the vital life force energies within our bodies so we can function on all levels -> physically, mentally, emotionally and spiritually. When all chakras are balanced and running in harmony, we will be living and feeling the healthiest and happiest! The root chakra spins the slowest, each chakra spinning faster as it moves up the body. Therefore the crown chakra spins the fastest. There is so much information that you can find about chakras, the following information skims the surface but gives you an idea of how these energy systems can give you a closer look into how these centers can store information about what is being held in the body.



THE SEVEN MAIN CHAKRAS

Root Chakra

CHAKRA 01 OF 07

‘Muladhara’ - root support

Location: base of tailbone



MAIN THEMES

1. Security and Stability: This chakra governs your sense of safety, stability, and basic needs such as food, shelter, and financial security. It's linked to feelings of being grounded and rooted.

2. Survival Instincts: The root chakra is associated with primal instincts and survival mechanisms. It involves your fight-or-flight response, ensuring physical and emotional safety.

3. Grounding and Foundation: It represents the foundation upon which we build our lives. A balanced root chakra provides a sense of being rooted, stable, and connected to the earth.

4. Physical Health: This chakra influences physical health and vitality. When balanced, it can contribute to a strong immune system, healthy bones, and overall well-being.

5. Family and Tribal Connections: It relates to our connections with family, community, and our sense of belonging. It's associated with ancestry and roots in one's heritage.

6. Material World and Manifestation: The root chakra also deals with our relationship with material possessions and our ability to manifest abundance and security in our lives.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

When the root chakra is balanced, one feels secure, stable, and grounded. However, imbalances in this chakra can lead to feelings of insecurity, fear, instability, or issues related to physical health and material concerns. Balancing and aligning the root chakra involves various practices such as meditation, yoga, grounding exercises, and energy healing techniques to address these themes and restore harmony.

Sacral Chakra

CHAKRA 02 OF 07

‘Svadisthana’ - One’s own home

Location: below the belly button / womb space



MAIN THEMES

1. Creativity and Passion: This chakra governs creativity, passion, and the ability to enjoy life's pleasures. It's associated with artistic expression, creative endeavors, and enjoying sensuality.

2. Emotions and Relationships: The sacral chakra influences our emotions and relationships. It's linked to our ability to form and maintain healthy, balanced relationships and to express emotions in a healthy way.

3. Sexuality and Pleasure: It's associated with our sexuality, sensuality, and the ability to experience pleasure. This chakra is related to enjoying physical intimacy and exploring one's desires.

4. Fluidity and Flexibility: The sacral chakra represents fluidity and adaptability. It's about going with the flow, being open to change, and embracing life's transitions without rigidity.

5. Creativity in All Forms: It's not only about artistic expression but also about creativity in problem-solving and innovative thinking. It encourages exploring new ideas and approaches.

6. Well-being and Vitality: This chakra influences overall well-being and vitality. When balanced, it contributes to emotional balance, pleasure, and a zest for life.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

Imbalances in the sacral chakra might manifest as issues related to creativity blockages, emotional instability, difficulties in relationships, a lack of pleasure or joy, or even physical ailments in the lower abdomen or reproductive organs.

Balancing the sacral chakra involves practices such as meditation, yoga poses that target the pelvic area, creative activities, expressing emotions in healthy ways, and energy healing to restore balance and alignment in these themes.

Solar Plexus

CHAKRA 03 OF 07

‘Manipura’ -Gem City

Location: above navel & below breastbone



MAIN THEMES

1. Personal Power and Confidence: This chakra governs one's sense of personal power, self-esteem, and confidence. When balanced, it fosters a strong sense of self-worth and self-assurance.

2. Willpower and Determination: The solar plexus chakra is associated with willpower, motivation, and the ability to set and achieve goals. It fuels the drive to take action and pursue ambitions.

3. Self-Control and Discipline: It influences one's ability to maintain self-discipline and control over thoughts, emotions, and actions. A balanced solar plexus chakra assists in managing impulses and exercising restraint.

4. Identity and Individuality: This chakra is linked to one's identity, individuality, and sense of self. It helps in developing a strong sense of self, separate from external influences.

5. Personal Responsibility: It encourages taking responsibility for one's actions, choices, and life circumstances. It promotes accountability and ownership of one's life.

6. Confidence in Decision Making: A balanced solar plexus chakra supports clear decision-making and confidence in choices.

7. Transformation and Personal Growth: It's associated with personal growth, transformation, and the ability to overcome challenges, leading to inner strength and resilience.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

Imbalances in the solar plexus chakra might manifest as issues related to low self-esteem, lack of confidence, feeling powerless or indecisive, or having difficulty asserting oneself. On the other hand, an overactive solar plexus chakra might lead to arrogance, controlling behavior, or an overly aggressive attitude.

Heart Chakra

CHAKRA 04 OF 07

‘Anahata’ - Unstruck

Location: Center of the chest



MAIN THEMES

- 1. Love and Compassion:** The heart chakra governs the capacity to love unconditionally, both oneself and others. It promotes compassion, empathy, kindness, and forgiveness.
- 2. Connection and Relationships:** It's associated with forming meaningful, balanced, and healthy relationships. This includes relationships with oneself, family, friends, romantic partners, and the wider community.
- 3. Empathy and Understanding:** The heart chakra encourages the ability to understand and empathize with others, seeing beyond differences and fostering a sense of unity and interconnectedness.
- 4. Healing and Harmony:** It represents emotional healing and inner peace. A balanced heart chakra helps in resolving past emotional wounds and achieving a state of emotional balance and harmony.

- 5. Self-Acceptance and Self-Love:** This chakra influences self-acceptance, self-worth, and self-love. It promotes a healthy relationship with oneself, fostering a sense of inner peace and acceptance.
- 6. Forgiveness and Letting Go:** The heart chakra encourages forgiveness, both of oneself and others. It involves releasing grudges and letting go of emotional baggage.
- 7. Balance between Giving and Receiving:** It's about finding a harmonious balance between giving love and receiving love without feeling depleted or overwhelmed.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

Imbalances in the heart chakra might manifest as difficulties in forming or maintaining relationships, issues with trust, inability to forgive, feelings of isolation, or a lack of empathy. Balancing the heart chakra involves practices such as meditation, yoga poses opening the chest, practicing gratitude, acts of kindness, self-care rituals, and energy healing to restore equilibrium and alignment within these themes.

Throat Chakra

CHAKRA 05 OF 07

‘Vishuddha’ - Especially pure

Location: Neck & shoulders region



MAIN THEMES

1. Communication: The throat chakra governs communication in all forms-verbal, non-verbal, and self-expression. It involves speaking truthfully, openly, and authentically while also listening actively and empathetically.

2. Self-Expression and Creativity: This chakra encourages creative self-expression through various mediums such as art, writing, speaking, or any form of creative communication.

3. Authenticity: It's about expressing oneself authentically without fear of judgment, staying true to one's beliefs, values, and feelings.

4. Clarity and Truth: The throat chakra represents clarity in thoughts, speech, and expression. It involves speaking truthfully and with integrity, avoiding lies or deceit.

5. Voice and Sound: It's associated with the power of the voice and the impact of sound. This includes not only literal speaking but also the tone, frequency, and energy behind the spoken word.

6. Listening and Understanding: It involves not only speaking but also the ability to listen actively and understand others without judgment or bias.

7. Creative Manifestation Through Communication: It's about using communication and expression as a tool for manifesting ideas, intentions, and desires into reality.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

Imbalances in the throat chakra might manifest as difficulties in expressing oneself, fear of speaking, feeling unheard or misunderstood, dishonesty, creative blocks, or issues related to throat and neck health.

Balancing the throat chakra involves practices such as meditation focusing on the throat area, chanting, singing, journaling, engaging in creative activities, practicing clear and honest communication, and energy healing to restore balance and alignment within these themes.

Third Eye Chakra

CHAKRA 06 OF 07

‘Ajna’ - beyond wisdom

Location: Center of brow



MAIN THEMES

1. Intuition and Perception: The third eye chakra governs intuition, inner wisdom, and heightened perception. It's associated with the ability to perceive beyond the physical realm and tap into deeper insights and understanding.

2. Clarity and Insight: It represents mental clarity, inner vision, and the ability to see situations, people, and oneself with deeper insight and understanding.

3. Imagination and Visualization: This chakra is linked to imagination and visualization abilities. It encourages the power to envision and manifest ideas or goals.

4. Spiritual Connection: The third eye chakra is associated with spiritual connection, transcendence, and an awareness of the spiritual aspect of existence.

5. Awareness and Mindfulness: It encourages a state of heightened awareness, mindfulness, and presence in the present moment.

6. Intellect and Intuition Balance: It involves balancing the intellect and intuition, integrating logical thinking with intuitive guidance for well-informed decision-making.

7. Inner Guidance and Trust: It fosters trust in one's inner guidance and intuition, allowing for a deeper sense of trust in oneself and the universe.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

Imbalances in the third eye chakra might manifest as issues related to lack of clarity, difficulty making decisions, feeling disconnected from intuition, being overly analytical, or experiencing headaches and vision problems.

Balancing the third eye chakra involves practices such as meditation focused on the third eye area, visualization exercises, dream work, cultivating mindfulness, exploring spirituality, journaling thoughts and insights, and energy healing techniques to restore equilibrium and alignment within these themes.

Crown Chakra

CHAKRA 07 OF 07

‘Sahasrara’ - thousand petaled

Location: Crown of head



MAIN THEMES

1. Spirituality and Higher Consciousness: The crown chakra represents our connection to the divine, universal consciousness, and spiritual enlightenment. It's associated with experiencing a sense of oneness with all that exists.

2. Unity and Wholeness: This chakra symbolizes unity and the interconnectedness of everything in the universe. It transcends individuality and emphasizes the understanding of the interconnectedness of all beings.

3. Awareness and Wisdom: The crown chakra is linked to higher states of consciousness, awareness, and spiritual wisdom. It encourages expanded perception and a deeper understanding of existence.

4. Transcendence and Liberation: It represents liberation from limitations, transcending the ego, and experiencing freedom from worldly attachments. It's about rising above mundane concerns and experiencing spiritual liberation.

5. Purpose and Meaning: The crown chakra is associated with discovering one's life purpose and finding meaning in existence. It encourages seeking and aligning with a higher purpose.

6. Peace and Serenity: It fosters a sense of inner peace, serenity, and harmony. A balanced crown chakra allows for a tranquil state of mind and contentment.

7. Connection with Higher Realms: It's associated with a connection to higher realms, spiritual guides, and divine energies.

BALANCE & REFLECTION

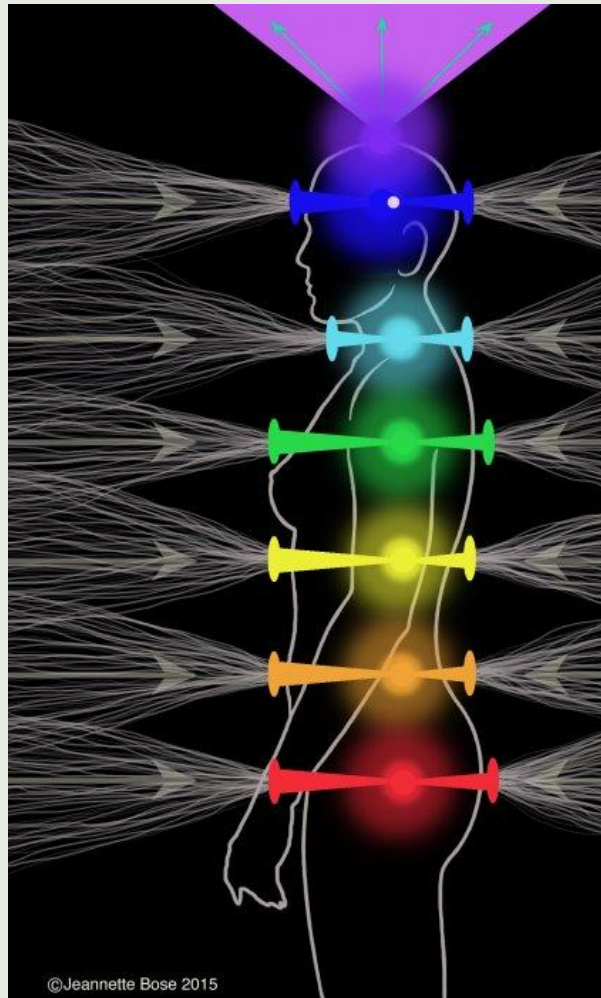
Imbalances in the crown chakra might manifest as feelings of disconnection from spirituality or a lack of purpose, mental confusion, depression, or a rigid attachment to spiritual ideologies.

Balancing the crown chakra involves practices such as meditation focusing on the crown area, mindfulness, contemplation, prayer, connecting with nature, seeking spiritual experiences, and energy healing to restore harmony and alignment within these themes.

The front and back of the chakras

Chakras have a front and a back.

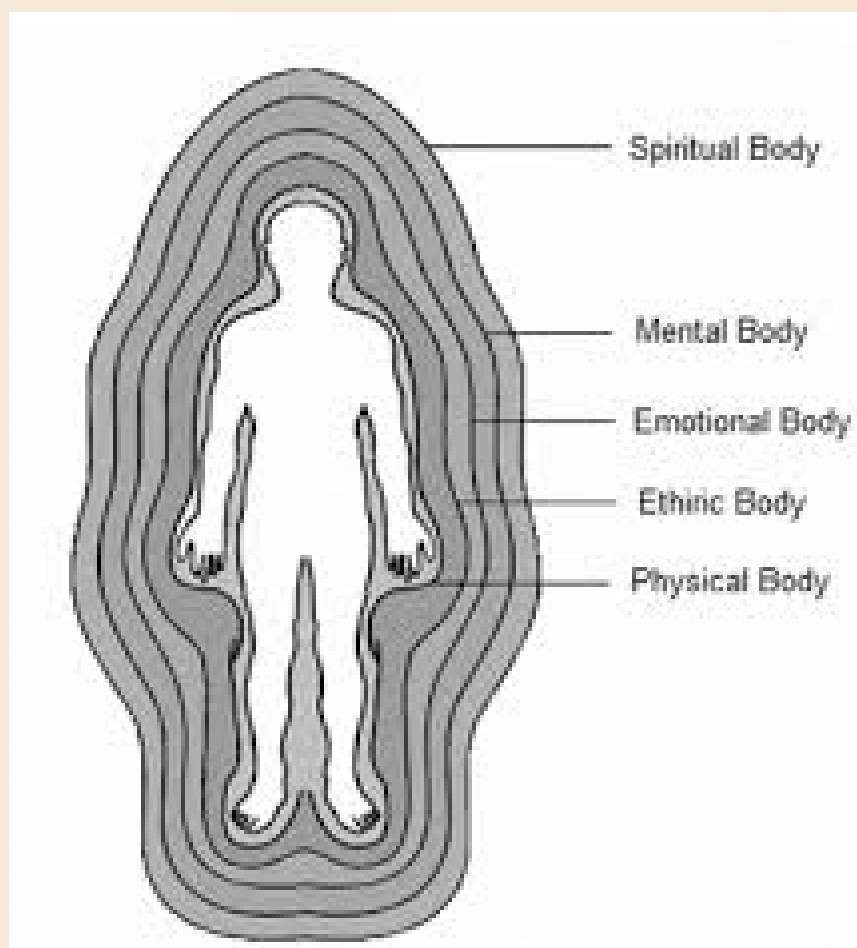
That is why we sometimes give Reiki to
a person's frontside and backside.



The Aura

“The Aura is a beautiful field of ever changing energy patterns that completely surround all living things.”

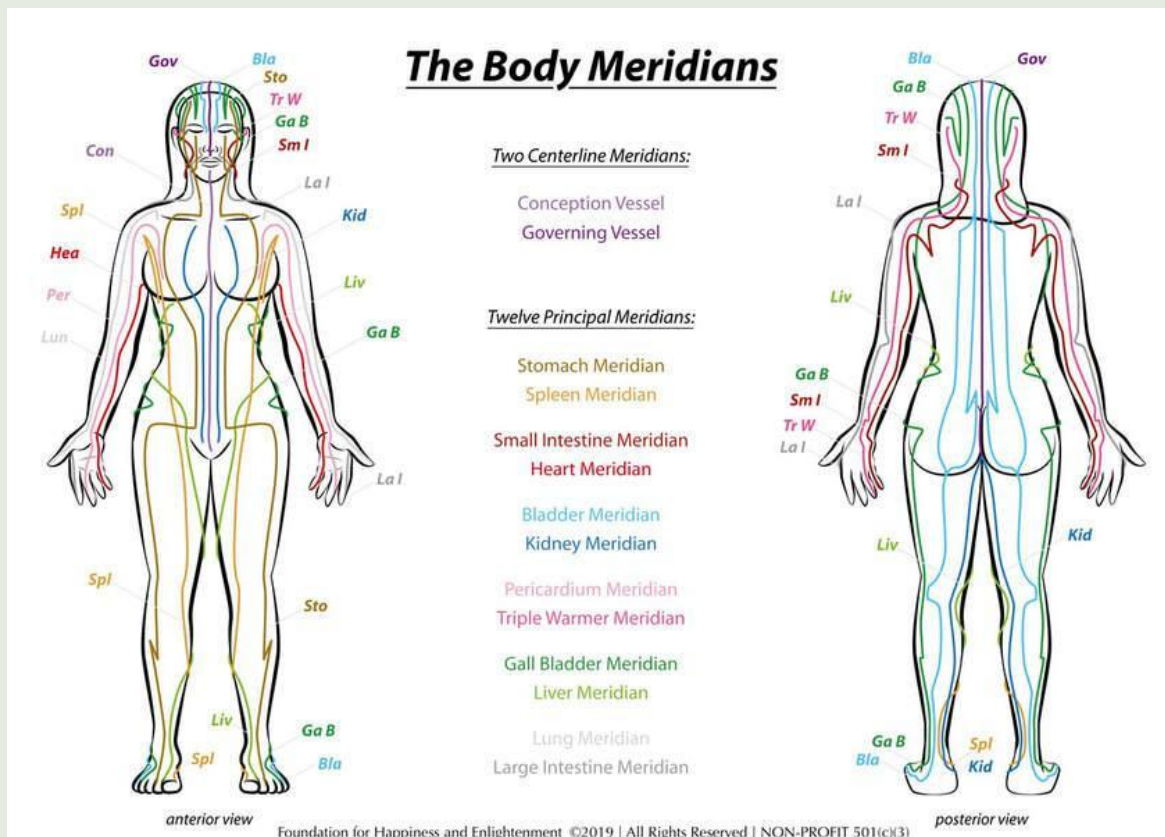
-William Lee Rand



Meridians

Meridians are 'energy highways' in the human body.

The spinning of the chakras intend to keep energy moving along the meridians and in and out of the body.



Grounding & Shielding

BEFORE A REIKI SESSION

It is so important to remember to shield and ground yourself before starting a Reiki session so that you provide a stable, clear channel for the Reiki and you are protected from the energy leaving the person/animal/thing you are sending the Reiki to.

Grounding

- Grounding Cord & Coil visualization (thoughts are electrical & emotions are magnetic)
- Growing roots into the ground as an extension of your legs & feet
- Are you feeling balanced? Are your feet firmly planted on the floor? If you are sitting, are you feeling comfortable and stable in your position?

Shielding

(protecting your energy)

- Visualize surrounding yourself with white light that fills your body, surrounds your aura & runs into the ground
- 'The Rose' visualization - a large rose(s) that rests in your aura and absorbs all negative energy
- Visualizing a suit of armor for protection
- Palo Santo - sacred wood that is said to clear out negative energy & also raise vibrations of the surrounding energies and spaces
- Sage- a dried and bundled herb, when burned is said to clear out negative energies and protect your energy.
- Selenite - a white mineral/crystal that is said to absorb negative energy and transmute it back into positive energy. You can use it to clear your client's and your own aura after a Reiki session.

Setting an intention for healing

Gasho Meditation ('two hands coming together')

The Gasho Meditation/Prayer is intended to bring focus to the palm chakras and to leave behind the sense of self, or ego, so you can begin the Reiki session.

An example of a prayer or intention to say in your head during this time:

"I ask for this healing for _____, for their highest good, in the softest and gentlest of ways. I give thanks in advance for the blessings to be received and ask that I be used as a clear channel for this healing, putting all ego and personality aside."

Reji-ho ('indication of the spirit')

The Reji-ho Meditation/Prayer is intended to help bring intuitive guidance to where the person needs Reiki.

An example of a prayer or intention to say in your head during this time:

"I ask my intuition to guide me in this healing and provide any information that I may need for the highest good of _____ (name of person receiving)."

The Gasho and Reji-ho are used as a ritual before beginning a Reiki session.

Before and after a session

ORDER OF EVENTS

Pre-Reiki Session

- 1 Wash your hands
- 2 Ground & Shield yourself
- 3 Gasho Prayer
- 4 Reiji-Ho Prayer
- 5 Body-scan (usually most effective with non-dominant hand)
- 6 Begin Reiki session

Post-Reiki Session

- 1 Seal the healing "I seal this healing with love and light" (3x) -one hand on heart and one hand on solar plexus
- 2 Closing Prayer
- 3 Brush down client's Aura (with hand motions or Selenite crystal)
- 4 'Ken'yoku' or dry bathing on yourself
- 5 Let client know the treatment is now over
- 6 Wash hands

Hand positions for treating self

TWELVE PLACES TO PRACTICE

- 01 Top of head (Crown Chakra)
- 02 Forehead (Third Eye Chakra)
- 03 One hand on each ear
- 04 Behind head, at base of skull
- 05 Neck (Throat Chakra)
- 06 Shoulders - if comfortable
- 07 Chest (Heart Chakra)
- 08 Above Navel (Solar Plexus Chakra)
- 09 Below Navel (Sacral Chakra)
- 10 Hips (Root Chakra)
- 11 Lower back
- 12 Feet - touch or beam Reiki there

Hand positions for treating others

Front side

- 01 Top of head (Crown Chakra)
- 02 Forehead (Third Eye Chakra) - *HOVER* - (do not touch)
- 03 One hand on each ear
- 04 Behind head, at base of skull
- 05 Around neck - *HOVER* - (do not touch)
- 06 Shoulders
- 07 Chest (Heart Chakra)
- 08 Above Navel (Solar Plexus Chakra)
- 09 Below Navel (Sacral Chakra)
- 10 Hips (Root Chakra)
- 11 Knees
- 12 Feet

Back side (optional)

- 01 Top of head (Crown Chakra)
- 02 Shoulders
- 03 Upper back (Heart Chakra)
- 04 Middle back (Solar Plexus Chakra)
- 05 Lower back (Sacral Chakra)
- 06 Base of spine or hips (Root Chakra)
- 07 Feet

What to do after Reiki Level I certification

- 01 Congratulate yourself!
- 02 Practice, practice, PRACTICE! Give yourself reiki once a day! Give your family, friends & clients reiki, give plants reiki & give your food reiki.
- 03 Receive reiki! It is just as important to receive reiki as it is to give reiki! You must maintain the balance. Although self-treatment is very helpful & cleansing, it is important to receive reiki from someone else because it does not always provide the full level of treatment and release you may feel from completely relaxing with someone else doing the work.
- 04 Work with the Reiki Ideals (Dr. Usui's life principles)
- 05 Remember to let go of certain expectations you have about giving reiki and just allow the reiki to happen.
- 06 Journal about experiences.
- 07 Feel free to reach out to me with any questions or concerns. :)